



The First Angel's Message

Sabbath School Study Notes

Lessons 1 & 2

PHASE 4 SDA BRANCH

Revelation 14:6-7

The First Angel's Message

THE FIRST ANGEL'S MESSAGE • LESSON 1 • REVELATION 14:6-7

R Recap

As a recap of our last lesson, we looked at the beginning of the Three Angels' Messages.

Revelation 14:6

*We discussed what the everlasting gospel is. Who remembers what the everlasting gospel is?
And where is it supposed to go? To Seventh-day Adventists only?*

Jesus came and lived and died.

Our conclusion in the last lesson is that God's Son has died such that if, let's say, Hitler believed as per John 3:16, he might not perish but have everlasting life.

So the gospel is to go — to the churches, to the prisons, to the heathen lands. To the whole world.

Today we will be looking at the first message itself.

Revelation 14:7

1 Saying With a Loud Voice

Isaiah 6:4-5

The angels crying "Holy, holy" in Isaiah 6 are speaking at the top of their lungs — if they have lungs — and as such the posts of the door are shaken.

1 Thessalonians 4:16

This loud voice of the archangel is what calls forth the dead out of their sleep at the second coming.

What does that mean to us? The gospel is a message to be preached in a powerful way. If the angel of Revelation 14:7 spoke in a low voice we would probably doubt what he has to say. But if I speak at the top of my lungs and say "I am Theo," that means it's something I'm sure and certain of.

So now to what the angel actually says — because until this point the angel hasn't said anything.

2 Fear God

The first two words are: Fear God.

Well, isn't that an obvious thing?

What does fearing God mean?

Proverbs 1:7

The fear of God means acknowledging a greater power than yourself. Secondly, realising that you are the recipient of wisdom and knowledge from God, who has it all. So this verse means that the person who despises the wisdom and instruction of the Lord does not fear God.

Proverbs 9:10

Knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. For you to know a person it is implied that a relationship needs to exist. There is a difference between knowing a person and knowing about a person. And God says that we should know him, not merely know about him.

And how do we fear God?

Genesis 1:1

The Genesis account is a symbol for why we should fear God. He deserves to be feared because he is the reason the earth exists. He created it all, including you and me. Our weekly cycle of six days of work and rest on one day is because of him. Might I just add that the greatest way to show how we fear God is by keeping the Sabbath.

Exodus 20:8-10

Verses 8-9 seem like an instruction from just any human being, but verse 10 gives the reason why we should do that. So by keeping the Sabbath we are acknowledging God not just as our Creator but as our Redeemer.

But if we have opened Exodus 20, it then means that the fear of God is also exemplified through the keeping of the Ten Commandments. Remember Proverbs 1:7 — fearing God is receiving wisdom and instruction.

Deuteronomy 4:4-8

That is what fearing God entails. There is so much more we can say regarding that but I believe this should be sufficient.

3 Give Glory to Him

The next part says: give glory to him.

John 17:4-9

How was the Father glorified?

Through the acts of Jesus Christ. Listen to verse 8 carefully: "They have known surely that I came out from thee and they believed that thou didst send me."

Philippians 2:5-11

Verse 11 — every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

Satan's argument in heaven was against Christ. He didn't acknowledge Christ's rightful position. What does it mean if we do what Satan did? We do not glorify God.

Glorifying God's name is lifting his name up through belief in Christ. Remember that it was through the life of Christ that we have come to understand who the Father is.

John 17:3

I hope we are starting to see why these messages are important.

NEXT WEEK

Assignment: Next week we are looking at the hour of His judgment. What does the phrase in Revelation 14:7 — **"...and the hour of His judgment has come"** — mean?

Give Glory to Him

THE FIRST ANGEL'S MESSAGE • LESSON 2 • REVELATION 14:7

Revelation 14:7

What is giving glory to God?

Let's take a slight detour.

1 The Detour: Moses and God

Exodus 33:12-18 (NKJV)

"Then Moses said to the Lord, 'See, You say to me, 'Bring up this people.' But You have not let me know whom You will send with me. Yet You have said, 'I know you by name, and you have also found grace in My sight.' Now therefore, I pray, if I have found grace in Your sight, show me now Your way, that I may know You and that I may find grace in Your sight. And consider that this nation is Your people.' And He said, 'My Presence will go with you, and I will give you rest.' Then he said to Him, 'If Your Presence does not go with us, do not bring us up from here. For how then will it be known that Your people and I have found grace in Your sight, except You go with us? So we shall be separate, Your people and I, from all the people who are upon the face of the earth.' So the Lord said to Moses, 'I will also do this thing that you have spoken; for you have found grace in My sight, and I know you by name.' And he said, 'Please, show me Your glory.'"

Moses is having a conversation with someone. Moses, as we read the verse, is talking to someone he's familiar with and even holding him at his word.

Who is Moses talking to? God!

The instruction has been given to leave Sinai and Moses converses with God.

Our primary focus last week was dealing with the fear of God. What do we remember about our discussion last week?

I want to ask a follow-up question: do we think Moses feared God? The answer is yes.

This answer corroborates what Proverbs 9:10 says.

Proverbs 9:10

It was clear that Moses knew God because, as he is speaking to God, he is referencing some of the things God has said to him in the past.

So we believe that Moses feared God. My second question: do we think Moses gave glory to God?

Yes.

Our lesson today is to help us understand what giving glory to God is.

We then make reference to the second part of the PDF shared last week.

2 How Did Jesus Glorify the Father?

John 17:4

We could simply end the lesson here because John 17:4 gives a direct answer. But we will take it very slowly so that we all get the point.

What was the work Jesus was given to do which he finished?

John 17:6-8 (NKJV)

"I have manifested Your name to the men whom You have given Me out of the world. They were Yours, You gave them to Me, and they have kept Your word. Now they have known that all things which You have given Me are from You. For I have given to them the words which You have given Me; and they have received them, and have known surely that I came forth from You; and they have believed that You sent Me."

The end of verse 8 is key. One might ask: Jesus preached the word or did good deeds, so what?

The end of verse 8 says that they may believe that You sent Me.

Why is it important that we believe that Jesus was sent by God?

John 3:16 — that we may believe that God so loved the world. How did he show he loved the world? He gave his Son.

There are people who commit sacrifices involving their children — what makes the sacrifice of God of particular interest?

Let's go to Philippians 2:6-8. Let's go back to John 17 — what does verse 5 say? Meaning that Jesus gave up, temporarily, the splendour of heaven to be made in our likeness so that he would die for us.

3 An Illustration

I want to give an illustration. We're in an economic crisis. What would happen if, let's suppose, the government is under shutdown and the leadership decides that they are going to forgo their benefits?

Every rich man in Botswana decides that they are going to share their resources so that everyone would benefit?

The answer is found in Acts 4:32-37 and Acts 2:44-47. There was unity and growth in the church.

Acts 4:32-37 | Acts 2:44-47

God sacrifices his Son because of love. The New Testament church did the same thing — why? Because of love. They did this in response to the message of the love God has for them.

4 The Cycle of Glory

We can bring it to a close now.

Jesus said that he had completed the work he was sent to do. But he wasn't dead yet. In all that Jesus came to do, he came to reveal the character of the Father. Everything tied to what Jesus says is always a reference to the Father above. It gets interesting now.

John 16:13-14

Jesus is now speaking of the Holy Spirit. He is glorifying the Holy Spirit by revealing its character and what it can do.

What will the Holy Spirit do in turn? Glorify Christ. And as such the cycle of glory, if you were to put it that way, is complete. All of this ultimately reveals the character of God in his three persons.

5 God's Answer: Glory Defined

Exodus 33:18 — Moses asks that God might show him his glory.

God answers that he will make his goodness pass before Moses. What is the goodness of God?

Exodus 34:5-8 (NKJV)

"Now the Lord descended in the cloud and stood with him there, and proclaimed the name of the Lord. And the Lord passed before him and proclaimed, 'The Lord, the Lord God, merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abounding in goodness and truth, keeping mercy for thousands, forgiving iniquity and transgression and sin, by no means clearing the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children and the children's children to the third and the fourth generation.' So Moses made haste and bowed his head toward the earth, and worshipped."

God shows his glory to Moses and at the end the Bible says that he made haste and worshipped God. Now what does all of this mean?

To give glory to God is to reveal his character. Which denomination are we in? Christianity — meaning? Christ-like.

6 The Great Controversy

In the Great Controversy, something important is recorded: the Great Controversy is between Christ and Satan. Satan's issue is with the authority of God.

Patriarchs and Prophets, p. 35.2

Little by little Lucifer came to indulge the desire for self-exaltation. The Scripture says, "Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty, thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness." Ezekiel 28:17. "Thou hast said in thine heart, ...I will exalt my throne above the stars of God.... I will be like the Most High." Isaiah 14:13, 14. Though all his glory was from God, this mighty angel came to regard it as pertaining to himself. Not content with his position, though honored above the heavenly host, he ventured to covet homage due alone to the Creator. Instead of seeking to make God supreme in the affections and allegiance of all created beings, it was his endeavor to secure their service and loyalty to himself. And coveting the glory with which the infinite Father had invested His Son, this prince of angels aspired to power that was the prerogative of Christ alone.

KEY DEFINITION

Glory is the visible presence of God. So we are showing God visibly through our characters. The question then is: are people seeing Christ? Or what about Christ are they seeing in you?

Questions for Reflection

Are people seeing Christ?

What about Christ are they seeing in you?

NEXT WEEK

We continue with Revelation 14:7: **"...for the hour of His judgment has come."** Come prepared: What is this judgment? When did it begin? What does it mean for us today?